

Hunter Burch

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on TensorFlow, cutting retraining from days to 4 hours.
- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 60%.
- Lifted recommendation click-through by 40% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in Scikit-learn.

QUALIFICATIONS

Master, Communications

Thornfield University | 2012 — 2013

Thesis: "Trust signals in digital public messaging"

Bachelor, Communications

Thornfield University | 2008 — 2011

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

AI Researcher, Cobalt Systems

2018-04 — Present

- Ran A/B tests across 10 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$100k in annual revenue.
- Trained and deployed Spark models serving 2M predictions per day at under 140ms p95.
- Mentored 6 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.
- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.

Applied Scientist

Spotify | 2017-01 — 2017-12

- Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 20 silent regressions before release.
- Developed an NLP classification system in MLflow reaching 88% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 45% across 8 regions.

Meridian Software — Junior Data Scientist

2014-12 — 2017-01

- Built the feature store that 4 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- Cut inference cost by 15% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on the in-house toolchain.

KEY SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, TypeScript

Frameworks: TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, LangChain, Pandas

Data: MLflow, Databricks, Snowflake, Spark

Testing & Tooling: Selenium, Git

PROJECTS

Personal finance tracker

Self-hosted spend tracker built with Snowflake. Deliberately kept the data local rather than using a hosted service.

Technical blog

Writing up Git experiments and failures, roughly 5k readers a month.

COMMUNITY

STEM ambassador running school workshops twice a term.